STUDY AID · MATTHEW 1 · EPISODE 1 OF 58

The Hidden Message in *Jesus' Family Tree*

God is with the outcast.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Channel: Every Word | 18:10 | LSB references

Full title: The Hidden Message in Jesus Family Tree REVEALED | Ep. 1 (Matthew 1). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT

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Summary · Passages · Family tree · People · Map · Terms · Hebrew & Greek · Background · Timeline · Cross-refs · Questions · Application · Copy all notes

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 1 aloud, then walks through what he noticed: a genealogy running from Abraham through David and the kings down to Joseph (vv. 1-17), arranged as three sets of fourteen generations, followed by the account of Joseph and Mary (vv. 18-25).
- He calls the genealogy 'more like a symbolic sketch' than an exhaustive

> *"Here's the lesson for the original audience: God is with the outcast.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

list, and asks what would have struck the first hearers, early believers who were probably Jewish and heard the Gospel read aloud, as unusual.

- The unusual detail is that Matthew names women: Tamar, Rahab, Ruth, Bathsheba ('the wife of Uriah') and Mary, when genealogies normally listed men. He links this to Joseph's plan to divorce Mary quietly, a detail he notes only Matthew records, and concludes that Mary, pregnant before the marriage was completed, would have been seen as a social outcast.
- His big idea: God is with the outcast. He tests it against Deuteronomy 10:17-19, Psalm 146:9 and Isaiah 61 (the passage Jesus read in Luke 4). God cares for the sojourner, the orphan and the widow, and His people must as well. He stresses this is about Christians serving the Lord, not about politics or government.

> ***"Since God is tremendously concerned with the outcasts, his people must be as well.***
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)



Joseph's dream (1:20)

James Tissot, The Vision of Saint Joseph, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



A medieval Tree of Jesse

Tree of Jesse, 12th-century illumination (1140s). Wikimedia Commons, public domain

The teacher's study method

Read the passage yourself and take your own notes. Look for what is **not typical** for the original audience, because that is a call to pay attention. Ask what the lesson was for them, test it against the rest of Scripture, then ask what it means for you. He also points viewers to his weekly reading plan (read the same passage all week and answer daily questions).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

Each link opens the chapter on read.lsbible.org.

[Matthew 1:1–17]

[Matthew 1:18–25]

The genealogy: Abraham to David, David to the deportation, the deportation to the Christ, fourteen generations each.

Mary found with child by the Holy Spirit; Joseph's plan to send her away quietly; the angel's message in a dream.

Isaiah 7:14

The virgin and Immanuel prophecy Matthew says is fulfilled (the video says 'Isaiah chapter 7').

Deuteronomy 10:17-19

God shows no partiality, executes justice for the orphan and widow, loves the sojourner.

Psalm 146:9

Yahweh keeps the sojourners and helps up the orphan and the widow.

Isaiah 61:1-5

Good news to the afflicted, release to captives, the favorable year of Yahweh; strangers and foreigners in v. 5.

Luke 4:16-21

Jesus reads the Isaiah scroll in the Nazareth synagogue (the video cites 'Luke chapter 4').

Luke 3:23-38

Mentioned only for comparison: Luke's genealogy lists fathers.

Key verses in the LSB

> “And she will bear a Son; and you shall call His name Jesus, for He will save His people from their sins.”
>
> Matthew 1:21 (LSB)

> “Behold, the virgin shall be with child and shall bear a Son, and they shall call His name Immanuel, which translated means, God with us.”
>
> Matthew 1:23 (LSB)

> “He executes justice for the orphan and the widow, and shows love for the sojourner by giving him food and clothing. So show love for the sojourner, for you were sojourners

> “Yahweh keeps the sojourners; He helps up the orphan and the widow, but He bends the way of the wicked.”
>
> Psalm 146:9 (LSB)

in the land of Egypt.”

Deuteronomy 10:18-19 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB NAMES

Three sets of fourteen

Matthew 1:1-17 as Matthew groups it (1:17). The **coral chips** are the women the video highlights.

FOURTEEN #1

Abraham to David

Abraham · Isaac · Jacob · Judah · Perez · ✦ Tamar · Hezron · Ram · Amminadab · Nahshon · Salmon · Boaz · ✦ Rahab · Obed · ✦ Ruth · Jesse · David the king

FOURTEEN #2

David to the deportation

Solomon · ✦ wife of Uriah · Rehoboam · Abijah · Asa · Jehoshaphat · Joram · Uzziah · Jotham · Ahaz · Hezekiah · Manasseh · Amon · Josiah · Jeconiah

FOURTEEN #3

Deportation to the Christ

Shealtiel · Zerubbabel · Abihud · Eliakim · Azor · Zadok · Achim · Eliud · Eleazar · Matthan · Jacob · Joseph · ✦ Mary · Jesus, who is called Christ

LSB footnotes give alternate Greek spellings: Asa (Gr Asaph), Amon (Gr Amos). The video reads the Asaph/Amos forms.

> *“You should be looking for things that are out of the norm... because that means something. That's a call*

out to pay attention.

From the video

04

Key people

What the video says, then a short background note.

Tamar

VIDEO Named in the genealogy as one of the 'outcasted women'.

BACKGROUND Judah's daughter-in-law; her story is in Genesis 38. Mother of Perez and Zerah.

Genesis 38

Rahab

VIDEO Named as one of the outcasted women.

BACKGROUND A woman of Jericho who hid Israel's spies; spared when the city fell. Commended for faith in Hebrews 11:31 and James 2:25.

Joshua 2 | Hebrews 11

Ruth

VIDEO Named as one of the outcasted women.

BACKGROUND A Moabite widow (Ruth 1:4) who clung to Naomi and Naomi's God, married Boaz of Bethlehem, and became David's great-grandmother (Ruth 4:18-22).

Ruth 1 | Ruth 4

Bathsheba

VIDEO Read in the video as 'the wife of Uriah, who is Bathsheba'.

BACKGROUND Matthew does not use her name; the LSB footnote gives the Greek literally as 'her of Uriah'. Her story is in 2 Samuel 11-12.

2 Samuel 11 | 2 Samuel 12

Mary

VIDEO Betrothed to Joseph; the video argues she would have been seen as a social outcast because of her pregnancy, yet God used her to bring the Savior.

BACKGROUND Matthew states she was with child by the Holy Spirit (1:18, 20). Luke

Joseph

VIDEO A just man, unwilling to put Mary to shame; planned a quiet divorce until the angel spoke to him in a dream; then took Mary as his wife and cared for her and the child.

tells the annunciation from her side (Luke 1:26-38).

Luke 1

BACKGROUND The angel calls him 'son of David' (1:20), tying him to the royal line traced in vv. 1-16.

Matthew 1

Abraham, Isaac, Jacob

VIDEO The patriarchs; the genealogy really starts from Abraham.

BACKGROUND God's promise that all nations would be blessed in Abraham's seed (Genesis 22:18; Galatians 3:16) is an LSB cross-reference for Matthew 1:1.

Genesis 22

David and Solomon

VIDEO The kingly line that runs all the way to Jesus.

BACKGROUND God promised David a son whose throne He would establish forever (2 Samuel 7:12-16), an LSB cross-reference for 1:1.

2 Samuel 7



Rahab and the spies (Josh 2)

James Tissot, c. 1896-1902. Wikimedia Commons, public domain



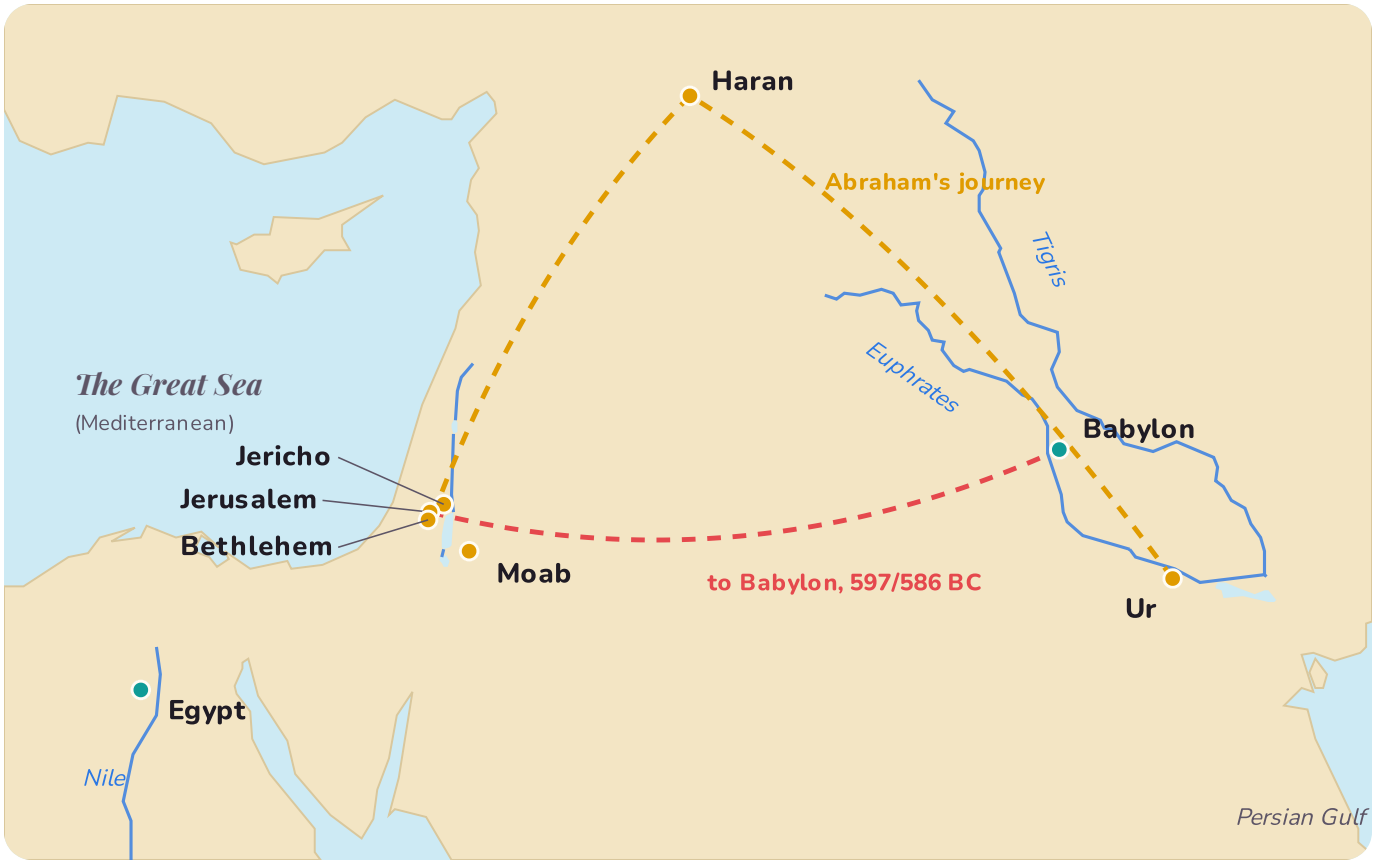
Ruth and Boaz (Ruth 3)

James Tissot, drawing, c. 1900. Wikimedia Commons, public domain

05 · BACKGROUND MAP

Where the story moves

Teal pins are places the video mentions; gold pins are background. Dashed lines: Abraham's journey and the deportation to Babylon.



Positions approximate. Coastlines and rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Abraham's route is schematic.

Babylon VIDEO
The deportation (1:11-12, 17)

Egypt VIDEO
'You were sojourners in Egypt' (Deut 10:19)

Ur BACKGROUND
Abraham's homeland (Gen 11:31)

Haran BACKGROUND
Abraham's stop on the way to Canaan

Jericho BACKGROUND
Rahab's city (Josh 2)

Jerusalem BACKGROUND
City of David and the kings

Bethlehem BACKGROUND

Moab BACKGROUND

Boaz and Ruth; David's town

Ruth's homeland (Ruth 1:4)

06

Key terms

Genealogy

VIDEO

Verses 1-17. The video treats it as a symbolic sketch built on three sets of fourteen, not necessarily exhaustive.

Outcast

VIDEO

The video's key word: people overlooked or marginalized for what others perceive about them.

Alien, orphan, widow

VIDEO

The video's 'common repeated phrase' for the marginalized: the sojourner (alien), the fatherless (orphan) and the widow.

Partiality

VIDEO

Deuteronomy 10:17: God shows no partiality and takes no bribe; the video notes humans are prone to it.

Betrothal

BACKGROUND

LSB footnote on 1:18: the first stage of marriage in ancient Jewish culture, usually lasting for a year before the wedding night, more legal than an engagement.

Immanuel

BACKGROUND

'God with us' (1:23), from Isaiah 7:14.

Christ

BACKGROUND

Greek for 'Anointed'; LSB footnotes render it 'Messiah' (1:1, 16, 17).

Deportation to Babylon

BACKGROUND

The exile marker in vv. 11-12 and 17; Jeconiah (Jehoiachin) was taken to Babylon (2 Kings 24:14-15).

Hebrew and Greek words

The video does not discuss original-language words. These are added; Strong's numbers for the Matthew, Deuteronomy, Psalm and Isaiah words match the LSB's own tagging.

All | Greek | Hebrew

Ἰησοῦς

Iēsous G2424

Jesus. LSB footnote: Hebrew Yeshua (Joshua), meaning 'Yahweh saves'.

Greek · Matt 1:1, 21, 25

יְהוֹשׁוּעַ

Yehoshua H3091

Joshua, 'Yahweh saves'; the Hebrew name behind Jesus.

Hebrew · background

Χριστός

Christos G5547

Christ, Anointed One (LSB note: Messiah).

Greek · Matt 1:1, 16-18

מָשִׁיחַ

mashiach H4899

Anointed one, Messiah.

Hebrew · background

γένεσις

genesis G1078

Origin, genealogy; 'birth' in 1:18.

Greek · Matt 1:1, 18

μνηστεύω

mnēsteuō G3423

To be betrothed.

Greek · Matt 1:18

δίκαιος

dikaios G1342

Righteous, just (the video: 'a just man').

Greek · Matt 1:19

ἀπολύω

apolyō G630

To send away, release; LSB note: 'Or to divorce her'.

Greek · Matt 1:19

παρθένος

parthenos G3933

Virgin.

עַלְמָה

ʿalmah H5959

Greek · Matt 1:23

Rendered 'virgin' in the LSB at Isaiah 7:14 (see the debate note).

Hebrew · Isa 7:14

Ἐμμανουήλ

Emmanouēl G1694

Immanuel, 'God with us'.

Greek · Matt 1:23

עִמָּנוּאֵל

ʿImmanuʾel H6005

Immanuel, 'God with us'.

Hebrew · Isa 7:14

גֵּר

ger H1616

Sojourner, resident alien.

Hebrew · Deut 10:18-19; Ps 146:9

יָתוֹם

yathom H3490

Orphan, fatherless.

Hebrew · Deut 10:18; Ps 146:9

אַלְמָנָה

ʾalmanah H490

Widow.

Hebrew · Deut 10:18; Ps 146:9

08

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Betrothal was legally binding

The LSB footnote on 1:18 calls betrothal 'the first stage of marriage… more legal than an engagement.' That is why Joseph is already called 'her husband' (1:19) and why ending it meant sending her away, which the LSB notes can be rendered 'divorce'. The LSB cross-references Deuteronomy 22:20-24 and 24:1-4 for the Law's background.

Matthew's list is selective

Comparing 1 Chronicles 3:11-12, Matthew moves from Joram straight to Uzziah (also called Azariah), passing over Ahaziah, Joash and Amaziah. This fits the video's point that the genealogy is not meant to be exhaustive.

Who Matthew wrote for

Early church writers such as Irenaeus (late 2nd century) linked Matthew's Gospel with the Hebrews. Modern scholars broadly agree it has a strongly Jewish-Christian orientation, which matches the video's picture of Jewish believers hearing it read aloud.

What Luke records Jesus reading

Luke 4:18-19 has Jesus read Isaiah 61:1-2a and stop at 'the favorable year of the Lord.' The video goes on to read Isaiah 61 through verse 5 ('strangers... foreigners') from Isaiah itself. Those later lines are part of Isaiah's passage, not part of what Luke records Jesus reading aloud.

DEBATED Where scholars differ

Why these women?

The video's answer: they were outcasts, as Mary would be. Other common proposals: Gentile connections (Rahab of Jericho, Ruth the Moabite, Bathsheba through Uriah the Hittite, possibly Tamar) pointing ahead to the nations; unusual unions through which God worked, preparing readers for Mary; and a display of grace to sinners. The views can overlap.

Why fourteen?

Matthew himself counts 3 x 14 (1:17). A widely proposed reason is that the Hebrew letters of David's name (D-W-D) add up to 14. Others see a simple memory structure. The third group also lists 13 names unless Jeconiah is counted twice, and interpreters solve that differently.

Matthew and Luke's genealogies

Luke 3:23-38 runs from Jesus back to Adam and differs from Matthew between David and Joseph. Proposed harmonizations include Matthew giving Joseph's royal or legal line and Luke Mary's line, or levirate and adoption links. Orthodox interpreters hold both are true; how they fit is debated.

Isaiah 7:14: ʿalmah and parthenos

Established: the Greek Septuagint translates Isaiah's ʿalmah with parthenos (virgin), and Matthew quotes it that way. Historic Christian teaching affirms the virginal conception, which Matthew states directly (1:18, 20, 25) and Luke confirms (1:34-35). Debated: the full range of ʿalmah and how Isaiah's sign related to Ahaz's own day.

From Abraham to the Christ

Coral dots mark Matthew's own turning points (1:17). Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

c. 2000 BC DEBATED

Abraham: God's promise of a seed and blessing to the nations

Genesis 12 *Start of Fourteen #1*

Patriarchal era

Judah and Tamar; Perez and Zerah born

Genesis 38

c. 1400 or 1200s BC DEBATED

Rahab shelters the spies at Jericho

Joshua 2

Days of the Judges

Ruth the Moabite marries Boaz of Bethlehem

Ruth 1

c. 1010-970 BC

David reigns; God's covenant promise of an everlasting throne

2 Samuel 7 *End of #1 / start of #2*

c. 970-930 BC

Solomon, son of David by Bathsheba

2 Samuel 12

597 / 586 BC

Jeconiah deported to Babylon; Jerusalem falls

2 Kings 24 *The deportation (end of #2)*

c. 538 BC

Return from exile; Zerubbabel helps lead the rebuilding

Ezra 3

c. 6-4 BC DEBATED

Jesus born to Mary, betrothed to Joseph, son of David

Matthew 1 *The Christ (end of #3)*

Cross-references

LSB cross-references come from the LSB's own margin for Matthew 1; the rest are added.

2 Samuel 7:12-16
The promised Son of David (for 1:1)
LSB CROSS-REF

Genesis 22:18; Galatians 3:16
The seed of Abraham (for 1:1)
LSB CROSS-REF

Ruth 4:18-22; 1 Chronicles 2:1-15
Parallel genealogy, Perez to David (for 1:3)
LSB CROSS-REF

2 Samuel 11:27; 12:24
David, Bathsheba and Solomon (for 1:6)
LSB CROSS-REF

2 Kings 24:14-15
The deportation to Babylon (for 1:11-12)
LSB CROSS-REF

Deuteronomy 22:20-24; 24:1-4
Law background to Joseph's plan (for 1:19)
LSB CROSS-REF

Luke 1:31, 35; 2:7
Conception by the Holy Spirit; the birth (for 1:18-25)
LSB CROSS-REF

Isaiah 9:6-7; 8:10
The Child and 'God is with us' (for 1:23)
LSB CROSS-REF

Joshua 6:25; Hebrews 11:31
Rahab spared and commended for faith
ADDED

Ruth 1:16
Ruth's confession: your God, my God
ADDED

James 1:27
Visiting orphans and widows in their affliction
ADDED

11

Reflection and discussion

1. Matthew names Tamar, Rahab, Ruth and 'the wife of Uriah.' Read Genesis 38, Joshua 2, Ruth 1 and 2 Samuel 11. What do their stories show about the kind of people God works through?

2. Joseph was 'a righteous man' and also 'not wanting to disgrace her' (1:19). How do righteousness and mercy fit together in his response?

3. The video urges us to look for things that are 'not typical' to the first hearers. What else in Matthew 1 surprises you, and why might Matthew have included it?

4. Deuteronomy 10:19 grounds love for the sojourner in Israel's own past: 'you were sojourners in the land of Egypt.' How does remembering what God rescued you from shape the way you treat outsiders?

5. Who is overlooked or pushed to the edge in your own circles of influence? What is one concrete step you could take toward them this week?

12

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The video's lesson for the original audience: since God is tremendously concerned with the outcasts, His people must be as well. The teacher asks each viewer to wrestle with that same lesson as it applies to their own life today, and to decide what to do about it in their own circles of influence.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

Matthew 1:21 says the child is named Jesus because He will save His people from their sins. The outsiders in His family tree point to a Savior who brings sinners in. Welcoming the overlooked is the fruit of having been welcomed by Him, not a way of earning it.

> *Matthew 1 is ultimately a reminder of God's heart.*
>
> From the video

13 · EXPORT

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